WONDER DAILY

H2O: Why Water Is Special

Three atoms

Every bit of water is made of molecules. Each H2O molecule has two hydrogen atoms joined to one oxygen atom.

Three states

The same water can be solid ice, flowing liquid, or invisible water vapor. Melting and freezing change its state.

Drops gather

Water molecules attract one another. At the surface, that pull gathers drops into rounded beads that can join together.

Surface tension

Surface tension makes the top of water resist being pulled apart. A gently placed paperclip can rest there without sinking.

Roomier ice

Ice molecules form a roomier pattern. Ice is lighter for its size than liquid water, so it floats on top.

Water dissolves

Water can surround and carry away tiny pieces of salt or sugar. That is called dissolving, but not everything dissolves.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!